Appendix A. Quick reference

A.1 HTML APIs and related libraries

HTML APIs are standardized interfaces provided by web browsers that allow developers to interact with browser features and the environment using HTML elements and JavaScript. These APIs are essential because they enable dynamic and interactive features—such as manipulating the DOM, handling user input, and accessing device capabilities—while ensuring consistency across browsers.

HTML APIs are built into browsers and defined by web standards, providing foundational features that offer additional utilities or abstractions but are not part of the browser itself. Table C.1 provides examples of common HTML APIs used in web development.

Table A.1 Common HTML APIs used in web development

API name	Description	Use case
Camera API	Enable developers to access device cameras for capturing photos or videos directly within web apps.	Allowing users to take profile pictures directly from their webcam in an app, using `navigator.mediaDevices.getUserMedia()`.
Canvas API	Enable developers to dynamically generate and manipulate 2D	Drawing interactive charts or creating 2D games on an HTML `<canvas>` element with `canvas.getContext()` methods.